

Product Requirements Document: SpendWise Expense Tracker

1. Executive Summary

SpendWise Expense Tracker is a lightweight, web-based financial management tool designed to help users regain control over their personal finances. By providing a centralized platform to securely log daily expenditures and visualize spending habits, SpendWise transforms fragmented data into actionable insights, enabling better budgeting and financial awareness.

2. Problem Covering

- **Fragmented Tracking:** Many individuals rely on manual notes or memory to track spending, leading to lost data and inaccurate financial pictures.
- **Lack of Visibility:** Without automated aggregation, users struggle to identify which categories (e.g., dining, transport) are consuming the largest portion of their income.
- **Complexity Overload:** Existing financial tools are often over-engineered with bank syncs and investment tracking, which can intimidate users looking for a simple, manual entry solution.
- **Accessibility:** Users lack a dedicated, secure web interface that allows them to log expenses quickly from any device without a steep learning curve.

3. Goals & Success Metrics

Business Goals

- **Centralize Personal Finance:** Establish SpendWise as the primary tool for users to record and review their manual transactions.
- **Drive User Engagement:** Create a habit-forming interface that encourages daily logging of expenses.
- **Ensure Data Integrity:** Provide a secure, private environment where users feel confident storing their financial information.

Success Metrics (KPIs)

- **Daily Active Users (DAU):** Target 1,000+ users logging at least one expense daily within the first 90 days.

- User Retention: Achieve a 40% retention rate after the first 30 days of account creation.
- Engagement Frequency: Average of 5+ expenses logged per user per week.

4. Target Users

- The Budget-Conscious Individual: Typically students or young professionals who need to manage a strict monthly allowance or salary. Their primary pain point is "hidden" costs that lead to overspending by the end of the month.
- The Organized Freelancer: Self-employed individuals who need to track business-related costs for tax purposes or reimbursement. Their primary pain point is the difficulty of separating personal and professional expenses in a simple interface.

5. Scope

In Scope

- Secure user registration and authentication.
- Manual expense entry (Amount, Date, Category, Description).
- Pre-defined expense categorization.
- Visual spending reports and monthly summaries.
- Responsive web interface for desktop and mobile browsers.

Out of Scope

- Native mobile applications (iOS/Android).
- Direct bank account synchronization or Open Banking APIs.
- Budgeting limit alerts or goal-setting features.
- Shared accounts or collaborative household tracking.
- Multi-currency support (Initial release is USD only).

6. Core Features (MVP)

User Authentication

Secure Sign-up and Login

Provides a private workspace for every user, ensuring that financial data is protected and accessible only to the account owner.

- Users can create an account using a unique email and password.

- Secure session management using JSON Web Tokens (JWT).
- Passwords are encrypted using industry-standard hashing before storage.

Expense Management

Core Transaction Tracking

The central hub for data entry, allowing users to create, view, edit, and delete their financial records with ease.

- Users can add expenses with specific fields: amount, date, category, and a brief description.
- A searchable and filterable list view of all historical expenses.
- Full CRUD (Create, Read, Update, Delete) capabilities for individual entries.

Expense Categorization

Logical Data Organization

Automatically organizes spending into recognizable buckets to help users understand their financial behavior.

- Includes pre-defined categories: Food, Transport, Rent, Utilities, and Entertainment.
- Users can filter their expense history by one or more categories to drill down into specific habits.

Spending Reports

Visual Financial Summaries

Converts raw transaction data into easy-to-read charts, providing an immediate overview of financial health.

- A dashboard "Snapshot" showing total spending for the current calendar month.
- A Category Breakdown (Pie Chart) showing the percentage of total spend per category.
- A Monthly Trend (Bar Chart) to compare spending across different months.

Post-MVP Roadmap

- Custom user-defined categories.
- Data export to CSV/Excel.
- Social login integration (Google/GitHub).
- Recurring expense automation.

7. Key User Flows

Flow 1: Onboarding and First Entry

1. User navigates to the SpendWise landing page.
2. User clicks Sign Up and enters their email and a secure password.
3. Upon successful registration, the user is redirected to the Dashboard.
4. User clicks the Add Expense button.
5. User enters "\$15.00", selects "Food", and adds the description "Lunch".
6. User clicks Save and sees the updated total on their Dashboard.

Flow 2: Monthly Financial Review

1. User logs into the SpendWise application.
2. User navigates to the Reports section from the main menu.
3. User selects the "Last Month" filter.
4. User reviews the Pie Chart to identify which category had the highest spend.
5. User clicks on a specific category in the chart to view the detailed list of those transactions.

8. Non-Functional Requirements

Category	Requirement	Target
Performance	API response time for data retrieval.	< 300ms
Security	Data encryption for all information in transit.	TLS 1.2+
Scalability	System capacity for concurrent users.	100k Total Users
Availability	System uptime and accessibility.	99.9% Uptime

9. Open Questions & Risks

#	Question / Risk	Status
1	Should users be allowed to create custom categories in the MVP?	Pending: Currently restricted to pre-defined list to speed up launch.
2	Is multi-currency support required for the first release?	Closed: MVP will support USD only; others to follow in V2.
3	Risk: Low user engagement if manual entry is too tedious.	Mitigation: Focus on a "Mobile-First" UI for quick entry on the go.
4	Risk: Data privacy concerns regarding financial records.	Mitigation: Implement strict JWT-based row-level security in the database.